

Automation Readiness Checklist

Forge RPA LLC · Version 2026-04-29

Time: ~10 minutes · **Audience:** VP/Director IT, Finance Ops, or transformation lead

Use: Self-assessment only—qualitative buckets (**Ready** / **Partial** / **Not ready**). This checklist intentionally avoids numeric scores, ROI, or phased methodology.

How to use

For each item, mark **R** (Ready), **P** (Partial), or **N** (Not ready). Add a one-line note where it helps. Patterns matter more than perfection.

Code	Meaning
R	In place, documented, and trusted day-to-day
P	Exists but inconsistent, informal, or fragile
N	Missing, unclear, or blockers known

1. Governance & ownership

#	Statement	R / P / N Note
1	Executive sponsor named for automation investments	
2	Clear owner for cross-system process outcomes (not only IT tickets)	
3	Documented change control for finance/ops-impacting workflows	

2. Process clarity

#	Statement	R / P / N Note
4	Top manual workflows named (not just “efficiency” goals)	
5	Happy-path steps written or demo-able for at least one workflow	
6	Exception paths acknowledged (not pretend “no exceptions”)	

3. Data & access

#	Statement	R / P / N Note
7	Source systems identified for the workflows you care about	
8	Path to read data exists without manual exports-only (API, DB read, controlled export)	
9	Security / privacy constraints understood for those datasets	

4. Tooling & integration landscape

#	Statement	R / P / N Note
10	Inventory of core systems (ERP, CRM, ITSM, banking, etc.) is current	
11	Sandboxed or non-prod environment available for validation	
12	Identity model understood (SSO, service accounts, least-privilege intent)	

5. Operations mindset

#	Statement	R / P / N Note
13	Team can tolerate pilot → refine (not “big bang only”)	
14	Runbooks or on-call expectations exist for production-adjacent automation	
15	Definition of “good enough” evidence exists for audits / controls where relevant	

Quick interpretation (non-prescriptive)

Pattern	Typical takeaway
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Mostly R	Strong candidate for structured discovery and scoped pilots
Mix of R and P	Common; prioritize documentation + access for 1–2 workflows
Several N on governance or data access	Address foundations before scaling automation spend

Next steps

- **Book a discovery call:** [forgerpa.com/book \(https://forgerpa.com/book\)](https://forgerpa.com/book)
- **Bring this checklist** (saved or printed) to orient the conversation

No dollar figures, scoring bands, or ROI models appear in this checklist by design.